Create a simple HTML-based authentication system

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Introduction:

The HTML Authentication Proof of Concept Assignment is designed to demonstrate a complete authentication navigation workflow using only core HTML concepts. The purpose of this assignment is to understand how web pages are structured, how user input is collected using forms, how data fields are organized using tables, and how navigation between multiple pages can be achieved using anchor tags without the support of CSS styling, JavaScript.

Authentication system is commonly used in websites and applications to allow users to register, login, recover passwords, and access protected dashboards. In real-world applications, these processes involve databases, server-side validation, encryption, and session management. However, this project intentionally avoids advanced technologies to focus entirely on HTML structure and semantics.

The Assignment contains five independent HTML pages interconnected through hyperlinks:

1. Login.html
2. Register.html
3. Forgot-password.html
4. Reset-password.html
5. Dashboard.html

All user interface layouts are created using HTML tables. Every navigation action such as Login, Register, Reset Password, and Logout is simulated through anchor (<a>) tags.

Objective of the project

The major objectives of this project include:

- Understanding HTML document structure.
- Learning form creation using <form> elements.
- Using tables for structured layout alignment.
- Applying input controls such as email and password fields.
- Implementing navigation between pages using hyperlinks.
- Understanding attributes such as required, colspan, align, href, and type.

Technologies Used

1. HTML5

2. No CSS styling, No JavaScript

Overall Authentication Flow
The navigation flow implemented is:
Login Page ----→ Dashboard Page
Login Page ----→ Register Page
Login Page ----→ Forgot password Page
Reset Password Page ----→Reset Password Page
Dashboard Page ----→Logout -----→Login Page
Each redirection is achieved using Hyperlink references.

Common HTML Structure Used in All Pages

Every HTML file follows a standard HTML5 structure.

1. **DOCTYPE Declaration**
   The declaration informs the browser that the document uses HTML5 standards. Without this declaration, browsers may switch into compatibility mode which can cause incorrect renering.

2. **HTML Root Element**
   The <html> tag is the root container of the webpage. All elements including metadata and visible content are enclosed inside it.

3. **Head Section**
   The <head> Section contains metadata about the document.

4. **Title Tags**
   The title tags defines the name displayed in the browser tab.
   Each page contains a different title:
   - Login
   - Register
   - Forgot Password
   - Reset Password
   - Dashboard

   This helps users identify which page is currently open

5. **Body Section**

   The body contains all visible webpage elements.

   - Heading
   - Forms
   - Tables
   - Input Fields
   - Anchor Links

6. **Login.html File Explanation**

   The Login Page allows existing users to enter credentials and navigate to other authentication options.

   I. Heading : The <h2> tag provides a visible heading. It gives semantic importance and structure to the document.

   II. Form Tag: The form element groups input controls.
   Although forms typically submit data using action and method attributes, those attributes are intentionally omitted because this project focuses only on structure.

   III. Table Layout: The table organizes fields into rows and columns.
   Attribute Used: border="1"
   Display visible borders around cells.

   IV. Table Rows: It will define the horizontal rows. And each row represents one logical part of the form. EX: Email row, password row, and navigation link rows.

   V. Table Data Cells: It will define columns, first column, field label, second column, input field.

   VI. Email Input Field: type="email", This ensures proper email format.
   Requied to prevents empty submission conceptually.
   name="email",identified field data.

   VII. Password Field: masks typed character. And ensure confidentiality.

   VIII. Anchor Tag Navigation: Login and the main purpose is to simulate login success and redirects to dashboard .
   Register -----→ register.html
   Forgot Password -----→forgot-password.html

   IX. Colspan Attribute : The main purpose is to combine two columns into one. And Used to center navigation links across table width.

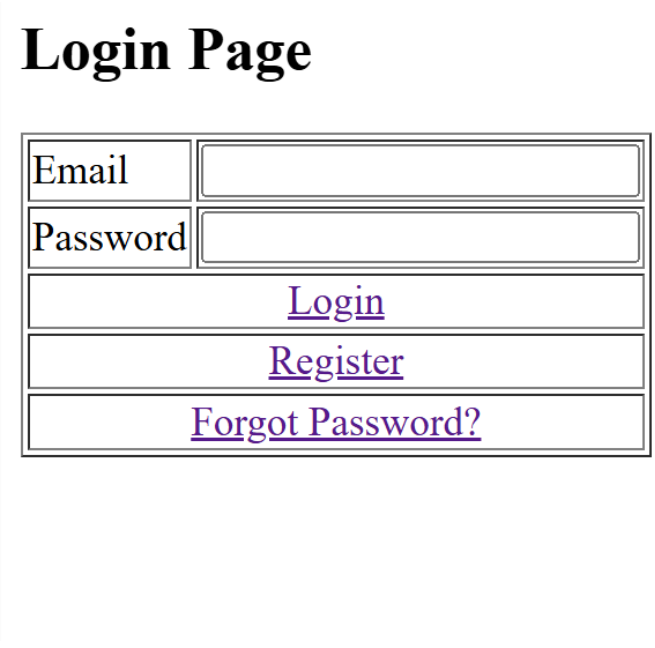
   X. Align Attributes : align="center" , the main purpose of this text horizontally inside table cells.

HTML CODE OF Login.html

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<head>
<title>Login</title>
</head>
<body>
<h2>Login Page</h2>
<form>
<table border="1">
<tr>
<td>Email</td>
<td><input type="email" name="email" required></td>
</tr>
<tr>
<td>Password</td>
<td><input type="password" name="password" required></td>
</tr>
<tr>
<td colspan="2" align="center">
<a href="dashboard.html">Login</a>
</td>
</tr>
<tr>
<td colspan="2" align="center">
<a href="register.html">Register</a>
</td>
```

```
</tr>
<tr>
<td colspan="2" align="center">
<a href="forgot-password.html">Forgot Password?</a>
</td>
</tr>
</table>
</form>
</body>
</html>
```

OUTPUT:



7. **Register.html explanation**
   This file allows new user registration.
   I. Input Fields :
      Full Name – Accept any character input.
      Email - Validate email structure.
      Password – Hides password characters.

Confirm Password – Second password field ensures re-entry confirmation conceptually.

II. Required Attributes
Each field includes required. And the purpose is to ensure mandatory input completion.

III. Navigation Links
Register Link: Represent successful registration.
Back to Login: Returns user to login page.

HTML CODE OF register.html

```
<!DOCTYPE html>

<html>

<head>

<title>Register</title>

</head>

<body>

<h2>Register Page</h2>

<form>

<table border="1">

<tr>

<td>Full Name</td>

<td><input type="text" required></td>

</tr>

<tr>

<td>Email</td>

<td><input type="email" required></td>

</tr>

<tr>

<td>Password</td>

<td><input type="password" required></td>
```

```
</tr>
<tr>
<td>Confirm Password</td>
<td><input type="password" required></td>
</tr>
<tr>
<td colspan="2" align="center">
<a href="login.html">Register</a>
</td>
</tr>
<tr>
<td colspan="2" align="center">
<a href="login.html">Back To Login</a>
</td>
</tr>
</table>
</form>
</body>
</html>
```

OUTPUT:

Register Page

Full Name	
Email	
Password	
Confirm Password	
Register	
Back To Login	

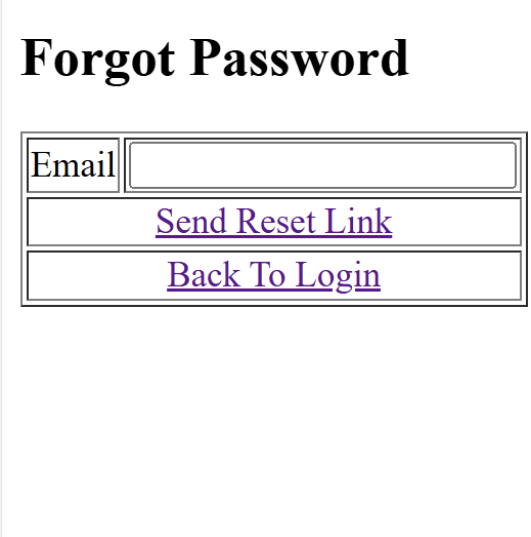
8. **Forgot-password.html explanation**
   The purpose is allow user to initiate password recovery.
   I. Email Field : Captures registered email. And email type ensure proper format.
   II. Reset Navigation : Simulates sending reset email link.
   III. Back Navigation : Allows return to login.

HTML CODE OF forgot-password.html

```
<!DOCTYPE html>

<html>

<head>

<title>Forgot Password</title>

</head>

<body>

<h2>Forgot Password</h2>

<form>

<table border="1">

<tr>

<td>Email</td>

<td><input type="email" required></td>

</tr>
```

```
<tr>
<td colspan="2" align="center">
<a href="reset-password.html">Send Reset Link</a>
</td>
</tr>
<tr>
<td colspan="2" align="center">
<a href="login.html">Back To Login</a>
</td>
</tr>
</table>
</form>
</body>
</html>
```

OUTPUT:



9. **Reset-password.html explanation**
   The purpose is to allows password replacement.
   I. Password Fields: it include New password, Confirm Password, and the purpose is to encourages password confirmation process.

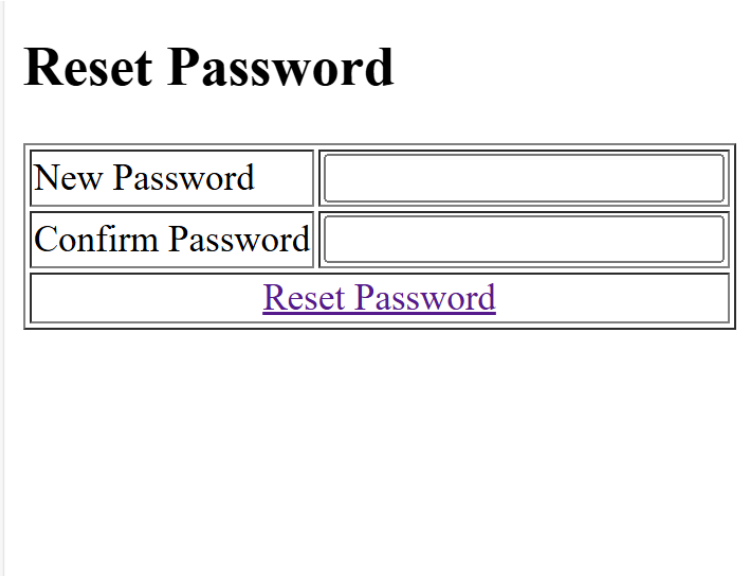
II. Reset Link : Represents completion of reset process. And Redirect user to login page.

HTML CODE OF reset-password.html

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<head>
<title>Reset Password</title>
</head>
<body>
<h2>Reset Password</h2>
<form>
<table border="1">
<tr>
<td>New Password</td>
<td><input type="password" required></td>
</tr>
<tr>
<td>Confirm Password</td>
<td><input type="password" required></td>
</tr>
<tr>
<td colspan="2" align="center">
<a href="login.html">Reset Password</a>
</td>
</tr>
</table>
</form>
```

```
</body>

</html>
```

OUTPUT:



10. **Dashboard.html explanation**

    The purpose is to represent authenticated area. And unlike others, dashboard does not collect user input.

    I. Table Structure : Display user information.
    II. Table Header : Define column headings.
    III. Data Rows : Displays static user data i.e Status, Active.
    IV. Logout Link : The purpose is to simulates logout functionality.

HTML CODE OF dashboard.html

```
<!DOCTYPE html>

<html>

<head>

<title>Dashboard</title>

</head>

<body>

<h2>Dashboard</h2>

<table border="1">

<tr>

<th>User Name</th>
```

```
<th>Email</th>
<th>Status</th>
</tr>
<tr>
<td>Pooja</td>
<td>pooja@email.com</td>
<td>Active</td>
</tr>
<tr>
<td colspan="3" align="center">
<a href="login.html">Logout</a>
</td>
</tr>
</table>
</body>
</html>
```

OUTPUT:

Dashboard

User Name	Email	Status
Pooja	pooja@email.com	Active
Logout		

11. **HTML Tags Used in Entire Project**
    Here the tags included i,e DOCTYPE, html, head, title, body, h2, form, table, tr, td, th, input, a, and each contributes structural or navigational functionality.

12. **HTML Attributes Used**
    type, required, href, border, align, Colspan, name, and each attributes improves usability and layout organization.

13. **Limitations**
    no database, no password encryption, no styling, no scripts, this is purely structural.

14. **Learning Outcomes**
    - Understanding HTML page structure.
    - Learning navigation without JavaScript.
    - Practicing form field design.
    - Understanding table-based layouts.

15. **Conclusion**
    The HTML Authentication POC successfully demonstrates a complete authentication navigation system using only HTML. Every page is carefully structured using semantic tags and table layouts to maintain clarity and alignment. Anchor tags simulate workflow navigation between pages such as login, registration, password recovery, and dashboard access. This project serves as a foundational learning model for beginners to understand how authentication workflows are organized before introducing CSS,Styling,JavaScript,validation.